categorical imperatives that move to action regardless of what the agent desires.

Prabhakara restricts the authority (***pramanya***) of language to the ritual instructions found in the Vedic scriptures (*shastra*). Vedic injunctions (*niyoga*) relate to an interconnected reality that has to be brought about (*karya*). It follows that the smallest significant unit of language is the sentence. Already existent (*siddha*) objects do not need verbal testimony in order to be known and have their natures established because perception and inference are means of knowledge for them. Since the *Vedas* are primarily concerned with enjoining ritual action, they cannot be an authoritative source of knowledge (***pramana***) for the existence and description of a supposedly already existent entity such as the ***Brahman*** held to be the Supreme Being by the *Vedantic* schools. This is hotly contested by the various schools of ***Vedanta***.

See ***anvita-abhidhana***

Further reading: Buitenen 1956; Hiriyanna 1993; Jha 1911 and 1964; Lipner 1986

Prakara: according to ***Nyaya***, a complex cognition is true when its structured content (*vishayata*) corresponds to its external object (*visheshya*) as it is actually characterised by its properties (*visheshana*). The components of the mental content are called *prakara*. ***Ramanuja*** applies the term to any entity that essentially depends upon something else.

Prakashatman (900–75 CE): *Advaita-Vedantin* author of the *Pancapadika-vivarana* who held that the underlying cause of experienced diversity is ***Brahman*** qualified by a power of cosmic ignorance called ***maya*** or ***avidya***. This force is neither real nor unreal (*anirvacaniya*). But it is a positive entity (*bhava-rupa*) since it differs from the mere prior absence of knowledge or blank ignorance.